

Μάρκου Αὐρηλίου-Ψευδο

Marcus Aurelius-pseudo and the Letter to the Senate

eul_aid: qww

Period: *Βυζαντινή* [Byzantine](#)
Dialect: *Βυζαντινή Ἑλληνική* [Byzantine Greek](#)
Domain: *Θεολογία* [Theology](#)
Format: *Ἐπιστολή* [Epistle](#)

The author is an anonymous 16th-century writer who composed a work in Byzantine Greek. This individual created a pseudepigraphon, a text falsely attributed to the Roman Emperor and Stoic philosopher Marcus Aurelius. No personal details about the forger are known, but scholars place them within post-Byzantine Greek Christian circles, likely in regions under Ottoman rule. The work was probably intended to use the emperor's respected reputation to lend authority to Christian theological or moral arguments.

The sole known work is a collection of Letters attributed to Marcus Aurelius. This text survives and is considered a forgery from the 1500s. According to modern scholars, this forgery is a significant example of early modern pseudepigraphy. It demonstrates how the symbolic power of classical figures remained potent centuries later, illustrating the appropriation of Marcus Aurelius's image as a philosopher-king for Christian didactic purposes. Academics regard it as an important piece for understanding the long reception history of Marcus Aurelius and the tradition of attaching moral or religious teachings to the names of revered pagan authorities.

Works (1)

- *Πρὸς τὴν Σύγκλητον Ἐπιστολή* · [Letter to the Senate, Testifying Christians as the Cause of Victory](#) · 4 passages